



K. MURALI KUMAR

Archana Kamath quits TT to pursue higher studies



Archana Kamath, a member of India's women's table tennis team that reached the Paris Olympics quarterfinals, announced her retirement from competitive sports to focus on higher studies.

The 24-year-old from Bengaluru, ranked 122 in the world, said she was moving away from the sport purely because of her love for academics. "It was not an easy decision for me to make, but if I have retired from competitive table tennis, it is only because of my love for academics. TT is an amazing sport that I have had the privilege of playing for a long time, and my love for it continues. I have never thought about nor played TT with financial returns in mind," the paddler said.

"I took a decision to pursue my higher education after the Paris Olympics by enrolling in a full-time, two-year Master's programme in Public Policy. I somehow felt inside that now was the time and that I did not want to postpone my academic pursuits any further."

The former national champion thanked the Indian Oil Corporation, Olympic Gold Quest, SAI/TOPS, the Department of Youth Empowerment and Sports (DYES, Karnataka), and all her coaches in her journey for helping her play the sport in a competitive manner.

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1 Top Indian race walker Bhawna Jat has been handed a 16-month ban for whereabouts failure by the Anti-Doping Disciplinary (ADDP) Panel of the National Anti-Doping Agency after she committed the offence in August last year. Bhawna, a former national record holder in the women's 20km race walk, was provisionally suspended by NADA in August last year. She was recalled from Budapest, where she had reached to take part in the 2023 World Athletics Championships. Her 16-month ban period will, however, begin from August 10, 2023, the date of her provisional suspension. Her ban will thus be over on December 10 of this year.

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2 Ace cueist Pankaj Advani of ONGC extended his dominance on the green baize as he completed a grand double by winning the senior snooker title at the Western India Billiards and Snooker Championships 2024 in Mumbai. Advani showed steely resolve to shrug off a strong challenge from Railways' Kamal Chawla 6-4 in a long-drawn final that lasted close to seven hours at the Khar Gymkhana billiards hall. Advani sealed his win with the frame scores reading 11-72, 31-58, 95-40, 52-42, 69-43, 43-74, 22-59, 75-62, 84-58, and 58-10. The Bengaluru-based Advani had earlier in the day defeated S. Shrikrishna in the three-hour session billiards final.

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